

# AI Log - BTC Capstone Data Setup and Debugging

Representative conversation: debugging project folder setup, relative paths, and weekly data inspection for the FA550 BTC dashboard.

## Context

The user was moving an existing BTC/Kalshi project into a new FA550\_BTC\_Capstone folder and wanted a clean implementation using relative paths. The project used BTC futures data, Kalshi 15-minute BTC contract data, and preprocessed weekly app files. The user specifically did not want hard-coded absolute paths and preferred VS Code terminal commands over Notepad-based editing.

## Representative exchange

User: "don't use absolute paths, use relative paths and give me the powershell to copy all relevant files to my folder FA550\_BTC\_Capstone. If you dont know where a file is located let me know"

Assistant: Provided a copy/setup approach using relative project paths, then adjusted after the user's first copy attempt showed missing live and Kalshi files.

User pasted search results showing the actual file locations under ClaudeContracts/btc\_kalshi and FA550\_BTC\_Capstone. The assistant used those paths to reason which raw and processed files mattered for the new project.

## Important debugging moment

The first inspection script was looking in the wrong parent directory and printed missing paths such as C:\Users\jorda\OneDrive\Desktop\data\raw\... instead of the project-local FA550\_BTC\_Capstone\data\raw\... The assistant revised the script to base all paths on the current project root rather than an external desktop path.

## Representative terminal issue

The user redirected the inspection output to a text file and hit a Windows encoding problem.

```
PS C:\Users\jorda\OneDrive\Desktop\FA550_BTC_Capstone> python .\inspect_data.py >
data_inspection_output.txt
UnicodeEncodeError: 'charmap' codec can't encode characters ...
```

## How the issue was approached

The assistant treated the error as a Windows console encoding issue, not a data issue. The fix was to make script output ASCII-safe or explicitly avoid characters that cp1252 could not encode. The assistant also adapted future instructions to the user's preference: run scripts directly from the VS Code terminal with `python .\script.py` rather than opening files through Notepad commands.

## Outcome

The project folder ended up with a cleaner relative-path structure. The user established that future run instructions should assume they are already in the FA550\_BTC\_Capstone folder using a VS Code terminal. This became a recurring constraint for the rest of the dashboard build.